

DEPARTMENT TWENTY-TWO
HONORABLE ALESIA JONES
707-207-7322

**TENTATIVE RULINGS
AND
PROBATE PREGRANTS**

CALENDAR DATE: July 30, 2026

ADVISEMENTS

Probate Notes: Probate notes are available in individual cases and are not posted on the public website. For more information on how to access case information through the court's public portal, please visit <https://portal.solano.courts.ca.gov>.

Civil Tentative Rulings and Probate Pregrants: Current procedures to advise the court of appearances and nonappearances in response to tentative rulings and pregrants remain unchanged. Probate pregrants and tentative rulings are not posted for conservatorships, guardianships, or any ex parte matters.

Appearances by Zoom: Remote appearances by Zoom are permitted except for MSCs, TMCs, trials or evidentiary hearings, or cases in which in-person appearances have been ordered. Persons appearing by Zoom are to be in appropriate attire. They are also to be in a quiet place where they can speak without interruption and clearly hear the proceedings.

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**PREGRANTS AND TENTATIVE RULINGS
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LINE

1

**CONSERVATORSHIP OF RENATE KOBERT
PR23-00029**

Petition For: (1) Court Order Confirming Conservatorship Assets Pursuant To Probate Code Section 850, Transfer Of Assets To Conservatorship Estate, And Order For Double Damages Pursuant To Probate Code Section 859; (2) Surcharge Of Respondents For Breach Of Fiduciary Duties; (3) Physical Elder Abuse And Neglect; (4) Attorney's Fees And Costs; And (5) Imposition Of Constructive Trust [Prob. C. §§ 850, 855, 856, 859, 2647, 4230, 4231, 4231.5, 4232, 4541, 4545, 4684, 4765, 4766, 4771; Civ. C. § 2224, 3287]

PREGRANT ORDER

The court on its own motion continues this hearing to September 24, 2026, at 9:30 a.m. in Department 22. Pending the re-set hearing the petitioner shall resolve the following issue:

The petition requests "Respondents to return to the Conservatorship Estate the amount paid from the Conservatorship Estate for their attorneys' fees, in an amount to be proven at trial". However, if this matter is uncontested, the petitioner must state a specific amount to be returned and a specific amount of double damages and attorney fees.

LINE

2

**IN RE THE ESTATE OF ALFRED SMITH WILLINGHAM, DECEASED
PR23-00421**

Administrator's Report and Second Account, Prob. C. §12200 and Petition for Additional Time

PREGRANT ORDER

The court has considered the Report and Second Account and Petition for Additional Time and finds that all notices were given by law. The court finds the estate is not presently in a condition to close and that continuing the administration of the estate is in the best interests of the estate and of persons interested in the estate. The court orders the estate administration is to continue for six months from June 18, 2026. The personal representative is to file either a third report of status or a petition for final distribution no later than December 18, 2026.

The Order to Show Cause is on calendar on August 20, 2026 and shall remain on calendar.

LINE

3

**IN THE MATTER OF THE RUBY J. FISHER LIVING TRUST DATED
NOVEMBER 25, 2013**

PR24-00380

Status Review of Payment and Mortgage Loan Status

PREGRANT ORDER

This matter was continued from May 14, 2026 and July 1, 2026. The court expected that the payments of \$70,000 to Robert Montgomery and \$60,000 to Ruby Collins be made prior to this court date.

Counsel and parties may appear via Zoom, in person, or by CourtCall and address the following:

Status of payments.

LINE

4

**IN RE THE ESTATE OF FRANCISCO RAMIREZ, DECEASED
PR24-00581**

First and Final Report of Administrator on Waiver of Account and Petition for Its Settlement, for Allowance of Statutory Compensation and Reimbursable Expenses to Attorneys, for Satisfaction of Allowed and Unpaid Claims, and for Final Distribution

PREGRANT ORDER

The court finds all notices have been given as required by law. The petition as supplemented is granted as prayed, except that release of liability and discharge shall be ordered only upon the filing of the *Ex Parte Petition for Final Discharge and Order* once assets are distributed pursuant to Probate Code § 11753.

LINE

5

**IN RE THE ESTATE OF YVONNE OWENS, DECEASED
PR25-00267**

First and Final Account and Report of Executor and Petition for Its Settlement, for Allowance of Statutory Compensation to Executor, for Allowance of Reimbursement of Additional Expenses to Executor, for Allowance of Statutory Compensation to the Attorney for the Executor, and for Final Distribution

PREGRANT ORDER

The court finds all notices have been given as required by law. The petition as supplemented is granted as prayed, except that release of liability and discharge shall be ordered only upon the filing of the *Ex Parte Petition for Final Discharge and Order* once assets are distributed pursuant to Probate Code § 11753.

LINE

6

IN RE THE ESTATE OF SCOTT D. CONNELL, DECEASED
PR25-00591

Petition for Letters of Administration and for Authorization to Administer Under the Independent Administration of Estates Act

PREGRANT ORDER

The court on its own motion continues this hearing to September 30, 2026 at 9:30 a.m. in Department 22. Pending the re-set hearing the petitioner shall resolve the following issues:

1. Petition, item 2.d(2): The petition did not provide any explanation as to why the bond amount should be different than the maximum required by Probate Code section 8482.
2. The petitioner has not used the correct Notice of Hearing form. The information required to be provided for a petition for administration of a decedent's estate is not listed on the *Notice of Hearing* form filed. It appears on the mandatory *Notice of Petition to Administer Estate form* (DE-121). The petitioner must file and serve this form to comply with Probate Code section 8100.

LINE

7

IN RE THE ESTATE OF CHRISTINE D. PRESTON, DECEASED
PR25-00591

First and Final Report of Executors on Waiver of Account and Petition for its Settlement, Petition for Final Distribution, for Allowance of Ordinary Attorney's Fees and Costs

PREGRANT ORDER

The court on its own motion continues this hearing to October 01, 2026, at 9:30 a.m. in Department 22. Pending the re-set hearing the petitioner shall resolve the following issues:

Petition, item 22: The petition states that the statutory compensation is \$25,000.00, however, Court Staff calculates the statutory compensation as \$24,000 (2% of \$800,000 is \$16,000, plus 1% of the next \$9,000,000.00 is \$1,000.00). The petitioner shall explain their calculation.

LINE

8

IN THE MATTER OF THE MIHALI GONCHAROFF 2020 FAMILY TRUST
PR25-00699

Verified Petition to Convey Real Property and Transfer Personal Property Pursuant to Premarital Agreement [Prob. Code §850] or in the Alternative, to Enforce Petitioner's Community Property Interests [Prob. Code §5021]

Opposition and Objection to Petition to Convey Real Property and Transfer Personal Property Pursuant to Premarital Agreement [Prob. Code §850] or in the Alternative, to Enforce Petitioner's Community Property Interests [Prob. Code §5021]

PREGRANT ORDER

This matter was continued from May 21, 2026 to finalize and file settlement with the court. Nothing has been filed as yet.

Counsel and parties may appear via Zoom, in person, or by CourtCall and report on the status of filing the settlement agreement.

LINE

9

**IN RE THE ESTATE OF BRENDA S. CASSANOVA, DECEASED
PR26-00080**

Amended Petition for Probate of Will and for Letters Testamentary and for Authorization to Administer Under the Independent Administration of Estates Act (filed by Camilo Gonzalez Rangel)

Objection to Probate of Purported Will [Probate Code §§ 8004, 8250-8251]

Petition for Letters of Administration and for Authorization to Administer Under the Independent Administration of Estates Act (filed by Robert John Hickman)

PREGRANT ORDER

This matter was continued from April 6, 2026 and June 3, 2026 to allow the petitioner to address issues with the petition. The court notes that an objection was filed and a competing petition which is on calendar on August 3, 2026.

The court on its own motion continues this hearing to August 3, 2026 at 9:30 a.m. in Department 22. Pending the re-set hearing the parties shall resolve the following issues with their respective pleadings:

As to the Amended Petition filed by Camilo Gonzalez Rangel:

1. Amended Petition, item 6: As the decedent was not survived by a spouse or issue, the first box that applies must be marked and the relevant persons listed in item 8.
2. The Vacaville Reporter is not a newspaper of general circulation for Fairfield. (See Prob. Code § 8120 et seq.) Publication must be done in a newspaper of general circulation for Fairfield.

As to the Petition filed by Robert John Hickman:

All issues resolved.

LINE

10

**IN THE MATTER OF THE GUYNEL VINCENT REVOCABLE TRUST
PR26-00094**

Petition of Trustee for Order Confirming Trust Ownership of Real Property and for Possession and for Attorney Fees and Costs Probate Code 850, 856, 859, 17000, 17200

PREGRANT ORDER

This matter was continued from June 4, 2026. Counsel advised the court that if he does not appear at this hearing, the court may dismiss the petition.

If counsel does not appear, the court dismisses the petition.

LINE

11

**IN THE MATTER OF THE WESNER 2003 FAMILY TRUST
PR26-00130**

Petition to Remove Trustee, To Appoint Successor Trustee and to Compel Accounting; Probate Code §17200(b)(7), (b)(10), (b)(12)

Respondent/Trustee's Objection to Petition to Remove Trustee, to Appoint Successor Trustee, and to Compel Accounting

Petition by Trustee for Order Directing Conveyance of Real Property to Trust; to Set Aside Voidable Transfer of Real Property; for Cancellation of Instrument; for Constructive Trust; for Declaratory Relief; for Double Damages; and for Costs and Attorney Fees

PREGRANT ORDER

At the ex parte hearing on June 5, 2026, the court suspended Penelope Wesner as trustee, appointed Edmund John Wesner as interim successor trustee, enjoined Penelope Wesner from accessing trust assets, and directed Penelope Wesner to provide an inventory of trust assets. The petitioner filed a second petition which is the petition currently before the court.

The court finds all notices have been given as required by law. Absent any objections, the petition is granted as prayed. The petitioner shall file a declaration regarding the amount of attorney fees and costs.

IN RE THE ESTATE OF MARK LAWRENCE SHRODE, DECEASED
PR26-00232

Petition for Probate of Will and for Letters Testamentary

PREGRANT ORDER

This matter was continued from June 1, 2026 to allow the petitioner to address issues with the petition. Nothing has been filed since the last hearing.

The court on its own motion continues this hearing to October 01, 2026, at 9:30 a.m. in Department 22. Pending the re-set hearing the petitioner shall resolve the following issues:

1. The original will is not on file. (Probate Code § 8200.)
2. Petition, item 1: The petitioner did not specify which newspaper will be used for publication.
3. Petition, item 3.a: Either (1) or (2) must be marked.
4. Petition, item 3.c: The decedent's address must be provided (Probate Code § 8002(a)(2).
5. Petition, item 3.h: Either (1) or (2) must be marked. Either (3) or (4) must be marked.
6. Petition, item 5.a: Either (3) or (4) must be marked. Either (7) or (8) must be marked.
7. Petition, item 6: Either (a) or (b) must be marked, and the names of the relevant persons listed in item 8.
8. Petition, item 8: Per the instructions on page three of the Petition for Item 8, the petitioner is required to list everyone named in the decedent's will.
9. Petition, item 9: The petition must also be signed by the self-represented litigant on the attorney signature line. (Probate Code §§ 1020, 1021; California Rules of Court, Rule 7.103.)
10. Notice of Petition, item 1: All of the names that the decedent was known by must be listed.

11. Notice of Petition, item 5: The petition requests full authority but the Notice does not. An amended Notice must be served and filed to give correct notice to all interested persons, heirs, and creditors.
12. There is no completed Duties and Liabilities of Personal Representative form on file (Prob. Code § 8404).
13. There is no Proof of Service on file showing all those entitled to notice have received it per Probate Code section 8110.
14. There is no proof of publication on file. (Prob. Code § 8124.)

LINE

13

**IN RE THE NATALIE G. NICHOLSON TRUST, DATED MARCH 30, 2010
PR26-00270**

Beneficiary Amy J. Fisher's Petition: (1) Demand Information; (2) To Compel Accounting; (3) Invalidate Amendment - Lack Of Capacity; (4) Invalidate Amendment - Undue Influence; (5) Removal Of Dee A. Bianco As Trustee; and (6) To Restrain Trustee from Using Trust Assets to Defend Litigation
[Cal. Prob. Code §§ 17200 et seq.; 16060 et seq.; 850; 859]

Respondent Dee A. Bianco's Objection to Petition: (1) Demand Information; (2) to Compel Accounting; (3) Invalidate Amendment – Lack of Capacity; (4) Invalidate Amendment – Undue Influence; (5) Removal of Dee A. Bianco as Trustee; and (6) to Restrain Trustee from Using Trust Assets to Defend Litigation

PREGRANT ORDER

This matter was continued from June 29, 2026 to allow the petitioner to address an issue with the petition. The court has reviewed the objection that was filed too late for the last hearing. The petitioner has not addressed the issue identified for the last hearing.

Counsel and parties may appear via Zoom, in person, or by CourtCall and address the following:

The petition does not state whether Brett Nicholson is survived by issue.

The parties shall advise the court whether they would be agreeable to participating in court-sponsored mediation.

LINE

14

**THE THOMAS ARENS SR. AND GEORGINA ARENS FAMILY TRUST DATED
NOVEMBER 2, 2006
PR26-00306**

Petition to Compel Trustee to Disclose Trust Terms and Request for Attorneys' Fees and Costs [Prob. Code §§ 16061, 17200]

PREGRANT ORDER

The court finds all notices have been given as required by law. Absent any objections, the petition is granted as prayed.

LINE

15

IN RE THE ESTATE OF ALPHONSO BLACK, JR., DECEASED
PR26-00334

Amended Petition to Determine Succession to Primary Residence

PREGRANT ORDER

This matter was continued from July 23, 2026 to allow the petitioner to address issues with the petition. The court has reviewed the amended petition filed July 23, 2026 and the Inventory filed July 24, 2026 which did not resolve all of the issues.

The court on its own motion continues this hearing to October 01, 2026, at 9:30 a.m. in Department 22. Pending the re-set hearing the petitioner shall resolve the following issues:

1. A Petition to Determine Succession to Primary Residence is not a Spousal Property Petition. This petition is used to transfer real property below a certain value outside of a formal probate process per Probate Code section 13151. The decedent was survived by a son who may be entitled to 50% of the property. The petitioner shall explain whether the son will sign an assignment to the petitioner.
2. There is no Proof of Service on the amended petition. Amended petitions replace the original petition for all purposes. (Cal. Rules of Court, Rule § 7.3(3).) Notice of amended petitions must be given in the same manner as notice for original petitions. (Cal. Rules of Court, Rule § 7.53(a).)
3. An amended petition replaces the prior petition for all purposes. (See Cal. Rules of Court, rule 7.3.) Amended petitions must include all the attachments referred to in the amended petition, even if they were previously provided in a prior version of the petition.

LINE

16

IN THE MATTER OF THE CORMAC C. AND JOY L. DOWNEY 2017 LIVING TRUST
PR26-00356

Petition for Order Directing J. P. Morgan Securities LLC and JPMorgan Chase Bank, N.A. to Transfer Personal Property to Ashleen Jensen, Trustee, and for Damages [Probate Code §§ 850-859]

PREGRANT ORDER

The court on its own motion continues this hearing to October 07, 2026, at 9:30 a.m. in Department 22. Pending the re-set hearing the petitioner shall resolve the following issues:

The petitioner's supplemental declaration states J. P. Morgan Securities LLC and JPMorgan Chase Bank, N.A. requested that an estate proceeding be filed to resolve the accounts. The petitioner shall clarify why she did not file an estate proceeding but instead filed an 850 petition requesting damages for accounts that are titled in the sole name of one settlor.

LINE

17

**IN RE THE MATTER OF THE RENATE M. KOBERT TRUST DATED
NOVEMBER 18, 2016, AS AMENDED
PR26-00357**

Petition for: (1) Suspension and Removal of Trustees; (2) Surcharge of Trustees for Breaches of Fiduciary Duty; and (3) Instructions to Trustee Regarding Use of Trust Funds for Payment of Attorney's Fees [Prob. C. §§ 2462, 15642, 16000, 16002, 16004, 16006, 16420, 16440, 17000, 17002, 17003, 17004, 17005, 17200]

Response to Petition for: (1) Suspension and Removal of Trustees; (2) Surcharge of Trustees for Breaches of Fiduciary Duty; and (3) Instructions to Trustees Regarding Use of Trust Funds for Payment of Attorney's Fees

PREGRANT ORDER

Counsel and parties may appear via Zoom, in person, or by CourtCall.
